

Moonsea Rising - 20240602

The Sun Still Rises

In the morning, waking from their night's ordeal, they find a formal invitation to Baron Ironclaw's dinner. It specifies, in no uncertain terms, that they arrive in formalwear. Beitris has her ceremonial vestments, but the others aren't so lucky. Asking about, they find a couple of off-duty tailors talking shop in the taproom of the Cock and Bull. Rivals, they begin lobbying the party to use their respective firms. The Velvet Blade and Silverweave's Fine Threads. Based on the Velvet Blade's tailor being an orc, and knowing who had invited them, and their rather unsavory prior association with House Silverweave, they follow the tailor to The Velvet Blade.

Finding a fine, Saville Row-style establishment, filled with the factors of noble houses and protected from the sooty outside air by magical air, they are greeted by Serge, the flamboyant tailor. He acts as though he cannot possibly accommodate Lennox on their time-frame, but changes his mind quickly at the mention of Silverweave.

He sizes up the three corporeal party members who need attire, and gets fast to his task when he hears for what the outfits are needed. Lirael tells him she needs something unique, which incorporates the eye patch appropriately. He charges them a pretty penny for the clothes, and tells them they may return in a few hours to retrieve them.

Paradise Regained

Leaving the Velvet Blade, Beitris surreptitiously consults the The Dagger, which leads them to a salvage yard by the side gate on the western edge by the docks. A sign, in Orcish, reads "Reclaimed Paradise". Taevyn immediately recalls the odd phrase the priest said to Beitris in their dream. The Reclaimed Paradise is a bustle with activity, largely orcs and gnomes, but conspicuously no humans. Consulting The Dagger, Beitris makes her way to the office under the guise of securing appropriate transport for the evening.

The owner, Clemeth Faulk, greets them and asks how she can help. A burly orc with comically deep goggles, she notices Lennox and asks if he was ever a competitive athlete. Beitris quietly tells Taevyn and Lirael to keep an eye out in case they are ambushed again. The lines of sight from the elevated shed are quite clear, and they watch as several people are running and jumping around the salvage.

Clemeth is soliciting Lennox for some professional event. She suggests that if he performs well on the obstacle course, there could be a good discount for them. The obstacle course is curiously free of soot in its air, again as though the winds are behaving. Taevyn and Lennox rush outside to try it, as everyone on the lot gathers around. Beitris and Lirael take this opportunity to check The Dagger and try and figure out where it's pointing.

In the middle of the room, the plans appear to be a massive, hundreds of feet long, iron vehicle, which apparently runs on tracks, and has amenities like a casino and a dining room. She points

them out to Lirael, and the two suss out that it's some kind of locomotive engine of gnomish design, which runs on rails. There's also a small pocket in the plans which is slightly thickened, and Lirael's detect magic definitely shows something there.

Outside, Lennox blasts his way through the obstacle course, battering things aside like a bull in a china shop. Takes the second attempt, studying the larger man's progress, and dances through it, avoiding the swinging elements in the larger man's wake, and beats the larger man's time, but barely.

Clemeth is impressed, and asks Taevyn if he'd ever considered competing in the arena. He says he would have, but his mom wouldn't let him.

Inside, Beitris locates and swaps the card of The Chieftan, pocketing the magical version. She and Lirael head outside as Clemeth is talking to the other two, potentially trying to talk them into competing in the arena.

Clemeth offers them a 20% discount on anything they might need. Lennox shows some interest in the plans, and tells them she's trying to build the first line between Melvaunt and Tgorsk, in Thar. She claims it can dramatically cut travel time between the cities. Beitris asks if she needs investors, and Clemeth tells her that House Marsk isn't exactly on good terms with the Kingdom of Thar. Beitris suggests that maybe private investment, not affiliated with her House might be more welcome, and Clemeth tells them to come back another time to discuss it.

As they're leaving, Beitris asks Clemeth if she knows a famous equestrian gladiator named Nikolai Steele. She furrows her substantial brow. "No gladiators named Steele, though there is a man named 'Nikolai' from Penaris. But he's a thug, associated with a group of bandits." Beitris asks about the bandits, and finds they're named The Iron Fist, lead by Uriah the Fist. As they leave, Taevyn mentions quietly to Beitris, "my father's name was Uriah."

In the Ghetto

As they make their way back to the Cock and Bull, they find themselves moving through a warren of hovels when arrows begin to rain down on them. Taevyn and Lennox both take arrows as the assassins move in. Lennox moves forward, hewing away with his axe as Taevyn goes into his kata. He cuts the man between him and Lennox, leaving him bleeding heavily as he whirls into a parry.

Beitris summons a Seraphim, which immediately besets the archer on the roof, which moves to flee it. A bolt flies from her forehead to the nearest assassin. Considering the wisdom it imparts, she attempts to command the furthest assassin to "leave this place, and report us slain." He seems unperturbed from her attempted control.

Two of assassins carefully draw dripping arrows from their quivers and fire at Taevyn and Lirael. They are both struck, and Taevyn immediately begins retching. The assassin by Taevyn draws a similarly envenomed dagger and slashes at Taevyn, missing him twice. The furthest bowman draws his poisoned arrow, but nicks himself with it, gagging and wobbling on his feet, as his arrow goes well wide of Lennox. The big man swings his axe, chopping heavily into the dagger-wielding assassin. Taevyn retches repeatedly, trying to keep his rapier between himself and his attacker.

Beitris' Seraphim swoops down on the daggerman, missing him, and Beitris heals herself, as her wounds are the most grievous. Meanwhile, the penultimate assassin fires his poisoned arrow, striking the priestess heavily, though she resists the venom. Lirael summons a thin shield of magical glass around herself, and casts a primal spell at Lennox, who seems to grow larger and more intimidating. The final poison arrow is drawn, but this bowman manages to cut himself as well, doubling over as his guts twist and cramp.

The nearest assassin moves his hands, and a fiery ring opened beneath him, into which he drops. Lennox manages to land a massive blow on him, and the man flops lifelessly into hole, blood gushing from a dozen wounds. One of the sickened assassins retches, trying to clear his poison from his system. Light blooms from Beitris, as healing bathes the party, and the Seraphim returns to its plane of existence.

A refreshed Lennox charges the nearest assassin, striking him a glancing blow. Sickened, Taevyn lurches along behind him, slashing at the assassin, but his illness robs him of his strength. Lirael mutters something and turns into a massive panther, slinking behind the nearest crates for cover. Doing a backflip up onto the crates, the assassin drops an arrow shot directly on Lennox, wounding the big man. Taevyn continues to take fire from the assassin on the roof near him. The furthest assassin fires three shots at Lirael, knocking her immediately unconscious. Beitris emits another bloom of magical healing, waking Lirael and bolstering Lennox.

Lennox leaps onto the roof, striking at the assassin nearest him. Taevyn tries to leap on the roof following, but doesn't make the leap. The assassin draws his rapier and slashes at Taevyn, cutting him badly. Lirael climbs to her feet and tackles the nearby assassin from the boxes, snapping her jaws at him and missing. The assassins call to fire on Beitris, and several arrows hit her in short succession. She moves to cover, healing herself as she goes.

Lennox unleashes a flurry of blows, smashing the assassin next to him, and shifts down the roof line for a better position. Taevyn attempts to flip up onto the edge of the roof, but botches the maneuver and tries to swing over to surprise the man above him. He doesn't quite manage it, and slashes at the man, catching him a glancing blow. He steps away from the two, and prepares his escape portal.

Meanwhile, the assassin by Lirael switches to his rapier, and misses her in steady succession. She leaps over him onto the roof, clawing and biting at the one trying to escape. She catches him a glancing blow with her claw, but he continues fumbling for his talisman. Beitris steps out, firing a divine lance at the escaping man, who keeps his feet. Filled with Lirael's magic, Lennox opens his mouth and screams. Primal sound wracks the nearby assassins, killing the fleeing man as the other two cover their ears. He moves into position as Taevyn tumbles up behind the standing assassin, slashing him with his rapier.

The assassins break and begin fleeing. The one between Taevyn and Lennox throws his arm up in the air, and falls upwards into a fiery hole above him. Lirael springs across the square, leaping on the far roof and biting the last assassin, as he drops through to world.

Beitris and Taevyn grab their healer's kits, stitching up the various remaining wounds and damage, so they might at least be presentable. Taevyn inspects the dead assassins, finding good equipment, and signet rings with a horned skull insignia. Lirael and Lennox both recognize it as a diabolic symbol, and they radiate magic.